

Case Study: UPI Payment Fraud

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud has become a common cybercrime in India, where people are tricked into approving payments without realizing it. A typical example is of a college student, Rohan, who decided to sell his old phone online. Soon after posting the ad, he was contacted by someone who seemed like a genuine buyer and agreed to pay through UPI.

Things took a turn when the “buyer” sent a payment request instead of actually transferring money. He calmly guided Rohan, saying he needed to enter his UPI PIN to receive the amount. Without suspecting anything, Rohan followed the instructions. However, instead of receiving money, his account was debited. This process was repeated a few times, leading to a noticeable financial loss.

Such scams usually follow a pattern. First, scammers build trust by acting friendly and convincing. Then, they trick victims into scanning QR codes or accepting payment requests. Finally, they misuse this trust to get sensitive details or approvals.

Students, elderly people, and those new to digital payments are often targeted. The impact is not just financial but also emotional, leaving victims stressed and cautious.

This case clearly shows that entering a UPI PIN always means money is being sent, not received. Staying alert can make all the difference.